ne Pollution, 1973;

(b) resolution A.159(ES.IV) - Recommendation on pilotage;

(c) SOLAS chapter V, regulation 19 on Carriage requirements for shipborne navigational systems and equipment;

(d) previous resolutions A.579(14) - Recomme ndation on use of pilotage services in the Sound and A.620(15) - Recommendation on navigation through the entrances to the Baltic Sea, which have been superseded by this resolution;

(e) the established routeing system (Route T) through the entrances to the Baltic Sea; and

(f) the established ship reporting system in the Great Belt Traffic (GBT) area,

BEING AWARE of the close relationship between safety of navigation and the prevention of pollution from ships,

NOTING that, at several places, the entrances to the Baltic Sea are difficult to navigate,

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NOTING ALSO that, owing to the risk of grounding or collision and the strong sea current, the navigation of large ships through the entrances to the Baltic Sea constitutes a potential danger of pollution of the entrances and of the entire Baltic Sea area,

NOTING FURTHER that loaded oil and chemical tankers, gas carriers and ships carrying a cargo of irradiated nuclear fuel, plutonium and high-level radioactive wastes (INF-cargoes) constitute a potential danger of pollution of the entrances to the Baltic Sea and a potential hazard to international shipping,

HAVING CONSIDERED the recommendations of the Sub-Committee on Safety of Navigation at its forty-eighth session,

1. ADOPTS, in accordance with SOLAS regulation V/10, the Recommendation on navigation through the entrances to the Baltic Sea, as given in Annexes 1 and 2 to the present resolution;

2. DECIDES that the said Annexes w ill enter into force at 0000 hours UTC on 1 December 2003;

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navigation through the entrances to the Baltic Sea, as given in Annexes 1 and 2 to the present

resolution;

2. DECIDES that the said Annexes w ill enter into force at 0000 hours UTC on

1 December 2003;

3. REQUESTS the Secretary-General to bring this resolution and its Annexes to the

attention of Member Governments and C ontracting Governments to the 1974 SOLAS

Convention.

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ANNEX 1

RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THROUGH

THE ENTRANCES TO THE BALTIC SEA

ROUTE - T

1 Ships over 40,000 tonnes deadweight, when pa ssing through the entrances to the Baltic

Sea, in view of the f act that 17 m is the maximum obtainable depth without dredging in the area

north-east of Gedser and that the charted depths, even under normal conditions, may be

decreased by as much as 2 m owing to unknown and moving obstructions, should:

.1 not pass the area unless they have a dra ught with which it is safe to navigate

through the area, taking into account the possibility of depths being as much as

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decreased by as much as 2 m owing to unknown and moving obstructions, should:

.1 not pass the area unless they have a dra ught with which it is safe to navigate

through the area, taking into account the possibility of depths being as much as

2 m less than charted, as mentioned above , and additionally taking into account

the possible changes in the indicated de pth of water caused by meteorological or

other effects;

.2 participate in the ship reporting system (SHIPPOS) operated by the Government

of Denmark; and

.3 exhibit the signal prescribed in rule 28 of the International Regulations for

Preventing Collisions at Sea, 1972, as amende d, in certain areas in the Store Baelt

(Hatter Rev, Vengeancegrund and in the narrow route east of Langeland), when

constrained by their draught.

2 Ships with a draught of 11 m or more should, furthermore:

.1 use for the passage the pilotage services locally established by the coastal States;

and

.2 be aware that anchoring may be necessary owing to the weather and sea

conditions in relation to the size and draught of the ship and the sea level and, in

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and

.2 be aware that anchoring may be necessary owing to the weather and sea conditions in relation to the size and draught of the ship and the sea level and, in this respe